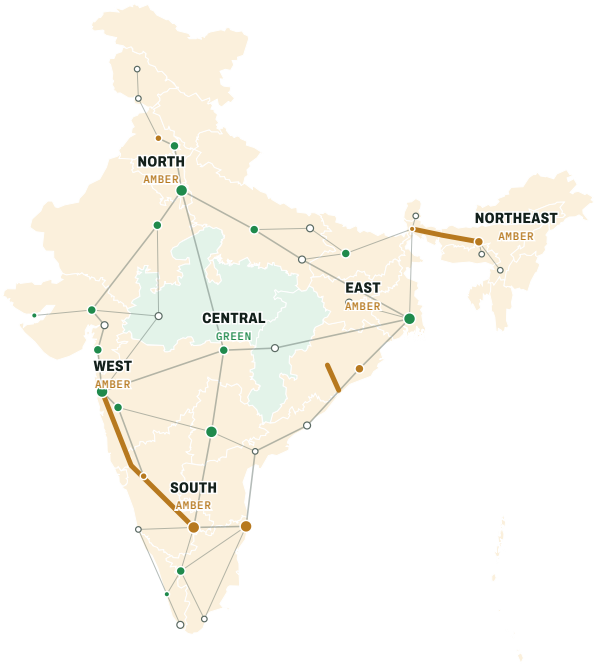
INB INDIA NETWORK BULLETIN · EDITION 011 SATURDAY 17 OCTOBER 2026 · 09:00 IST

# Fewer cash orders, and a longer queue at Kandla

● NETWORK: AMBER

For the first time, more than half of the sale's D2C parcels were paid for upfront, by ClickPost's count of 200 brands[1]. At Kandla, 72 ships were waiting for a berth on Friday, up from 56 a fortnight earlier[2]. And in the south, the cane march heads for Hubballi along the Pune–Bengaluru highway[3], while six Tamil Nadu districts are under an orange alert today[4].

## HOW'S EACH REGION HOLDING UP?




Map: DataMeet, CC BY 4.0

### DATES TO WATCH

| | |
|---|---|
| ● Sat 17 Oct | Orange alert in six Tamil Nadu districts |
| ● 17–20 Oct | Cane march into Hubballi; rally on the 20th |
| ● 17–24 Oct | Kolkata Puja curbs and immersions |
| ● 17–24 Oct | Petrapole–Benapole shut to cargo |
| ● 17–20 Oct | Air India's Saudi flights cancelled[5] |
| ● 17–24 Oct | IndiGo's Saudi flights cancelled[6] |
| ● 26–27 Oct | Kolkata Puja curbs and immersions, again |
| ● 26 Oct–5 Nov | NH-10 night closures[7] |
| ● Sat 31 Oct | Delhi's BS-IV entry window ends[8] |
| ● Sun 1 Nov | CMA CGM's new North Europe–India rates[9] |

● GREEN — the sale season as usual, which can still be busy
● AMBER — something beyond the season is slowing freight
● RED — something is stopping freight across a state or a route
○ — a hub not rated today

**North** ● AMBER

Thursday's Punjab bandh is over, but a hub takes about two days to work off a day of held loads. I'd expect Ludhiana's hubs to finish clearing them tonight, and Punjab deliveries to be back on time by Monday.

**West** ● AMBER

Kandla's queue of ships is the West's one trouble beyond the season. I'd expect bulk export trucks bound for the port to keep waiting in Gandhidham's yards all next week. Mumbai and Pune carry the sale's usual strain, with no delay beyond the season.

**South** ● AMBER

Six Tamil Nadu districts, Tiruvallur and Kancheepuram among them, are under an orange alert today, after waterlogging held up GST Road and the Porur toll plaza and a cave-in near Kancheepuram stopped trains[4]. I'd expect Chennai deliveries to slip half a day today and tomorrow, on top of the cane march's drag on NH-48.

**East** ● AMBER

Petrapole's eight-day cargo halt starts today. I'd expect Kolkata's exporters to hold Bangladesh loads in their own godowns until the border reopens on the 25th. Kolkata ran up to 38 points over its usual traffic before dawn, Saptami's usual strain under the Puja curbs[10,11].

**Northeast** ● AMBER

No report since Tuesday says the Assam coke trucks held at the Bengal border have moved. I'd expect Assam's refinery coke to keep missing the calciners that buy it until Bengal's tax officers let the trucks in, so at least another week.

**Central** ● GREEN

Nothing beyond the sale's usual load at Nagpur or Raipur this morning, so no delay beyond the season.

NETWORK INSIGHTS

## 1 More paid upfront, fewer coming back?

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE



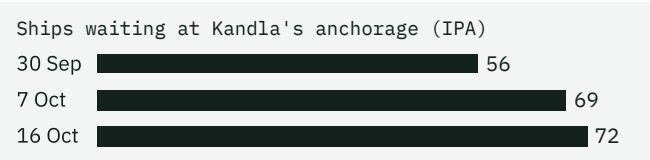

Prepaid passed half of D2C festive shipments for the first time, ClickPost reports: 52% across 200 brands in the sale's first four days, against 46% last year[1]. Prepaid grew 47% and cash on delivery 27%. The late parcels haven't eased: 21 of 222 Amazon app reviews on 15th October named a delivery problem, still about one in ten, and Flipkart's share has nearly tripled since early October[12]. Why does that matter on a truck? Well, a cash order can be refused at the door, and then it rides all the way back. Madurai showed the extreme this week, when a creator's followers sent him cash orders he never placed, TVs and fridges included, and Amazon and Flipkart agents kept turning up[13]. My guess is the first refusals from the sale's opening week reach return hubs from Monday, fewer for every thousand parcels than last Diwali.

> **Brands selling online gain most: every cash order that becomes a prepaid one is a return trip they don't pay for. Carriers and 3PLs still carry the refusals that remain, and in a small town a failed attempt costs as much as a delivery.**

## 2 Dearer boxes to the Gulf, and 72 ships at Kandla

Bulk and bagged exports through Kandla

AMBER · HIGH COST OF DELAY · HIGH CONFIDENCE

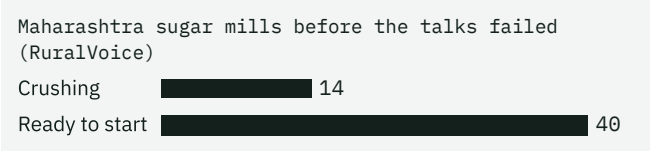



Kandla had 72 ships waiting at anchorage on Friday, 50 of them ready to berth, from 56 on 30th September[2]. ET Infra puts the port's usual line at 30 to 35[14]. Why the jump? The chairman told Maritime Gateway that dearer container rates to the Middle East moved rice exporters onto conventional ships, which need Kandla's dry-cargo berths, and some now wait 20 to 25 days[15]. For now, some rice loads at an oil jetty instead[14]. So the Gulf's container problem has turned into a berth problem in Gujarat. And those rates have no reason to ease: BBC Verify counted 12 ships attacked around Hormuz in the week to 11th October, a weekly record[16]. I'd expect the line to stay above 60 ships into November.

> **Manufacturers and exporters shipping bulk or bagged cargo through Kandla carry the wait: a contract priced on last month's freight loses money with every day at anchor. Carriers serving the port lose trucks to yard queues just as the sale needs them inland.**

## 3 Will the cane mills start on time?

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE




Maharashtra's mills brought crushing forward to 8th October because the cane was drying out, but after the Delhi talks failed, the ones that hadn't started put it off, RuralVoice reports[17]. Raju Shetti's farmers, from Kolhapur and Sangli to Belagavi and Bagalkot, now want every mill stopped until their demands are met, with a big rally in Hubballi on Tuesday[17]. Will it end quickly? The gap is wide: the Centre's fair price for cane this season is ₹3,650 a tonne, and Karnataka's growers want ₹5,500[18]. Even in a normal year, a Mandya grower told the same paper, the mills don't always take the cane on time, and a crop meant for 12 months stands for 14 or 15[18]. Why does a mill's start date matter to freight? It's two flows, actually: cane into the mills by truck and tractor, and sugar out of them in the weeks before Diwali. My guess is a late start squeezes the season's cane haulage into fewer weeks from November, crowding the roads around Kolhapur and Belagavi.

> **Manufacturers who buy sugar for sweets, drinks and biscuits face thinner mill dispatches before Diwali if the stop holds past Tuesday. Carriers and 3PLs that haul for the mills lose a fortnight's work now and get it back all at once later.**

THE LANES I'M WATCHING

### NH-48 Belagavi–Hubballi

AMBER

THE CANE MARCH, TOWARDS KITTUR

Farmers walked on from Belagavi towards Kittur on Friday; their leader says they'll reach Hubballi within two days and expects half a million people[3]. They say they'll go home if the Centre promises to meet their demands[19]. Hattargi's toll plaza counted about 2,300 heavy trucks a day last October[20], so a march at walking pace holds up a lot of freight. I'd expect Pune–Bengaluru trucks to crawl behind the march today and tomorrow, and Hubballi's hub to run half a day late into Monday.

### NH-112 Bongaon–Petrapole

AMBER

THE LAND BORDER TO BANGLADESH

Petrapole takes no cargo from today to the 21st, and Benapole on the Bangladesh side stays shut from the 20th to the 24th, so trade restarts on the 25th[21]. Benapole reckons 300 to 350 truckloads a day come in from India, so the halt holds back something like 2,400 to 2,800 loads, industrial raw materials among them[21]. I'd expect trucks that reach Bongaon anyway to wait out the eight days there, with detention on every one, and the whole backlog to try to cross in the week from the 25th.

### NH-27 at Srirampur

● AMBER

ASSAM'S ROAD OUT TO BIHAR

Tuesday's count was more than 300 trucks of Assam petroleum coke refused entry to Bengal, their GST papers in order[22]. That's a parked fleet the size of about two hours of this road's traffic: Panikauri's toll plaza counted about 4,100 heavy trucks a day last October[20]. My guess is the coke stays held there into next weekend, and every day adds to the detention bill.

### NH-157 Kalinga ghat

● AMBER

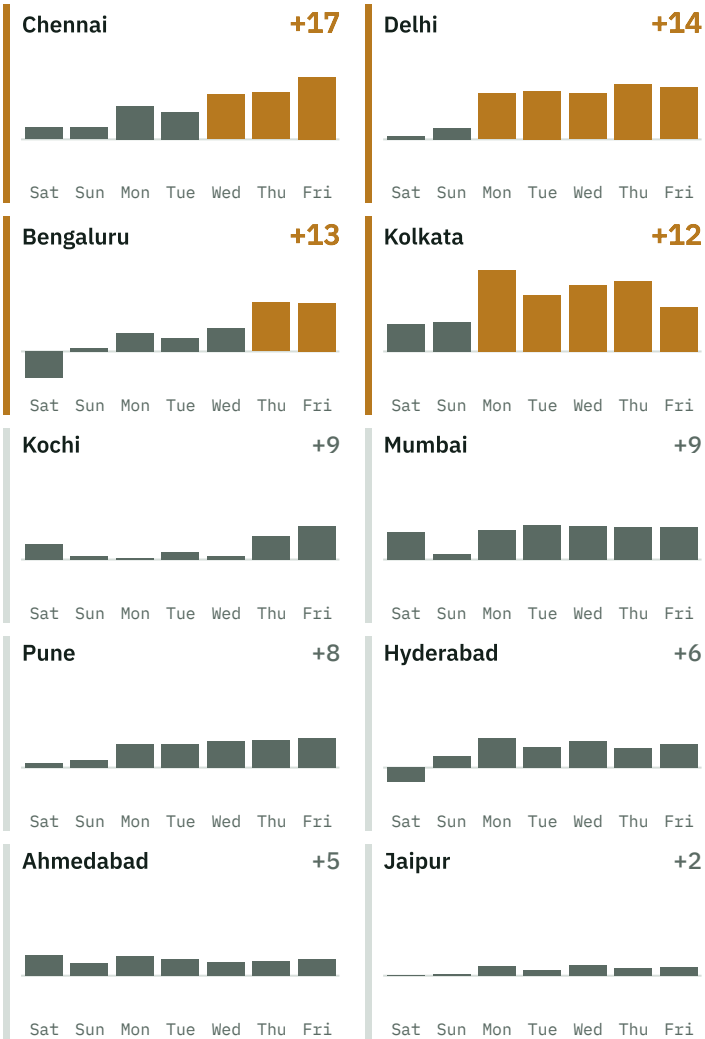
GANJAM TO KANDHAMAL, ODISHA

The ghat road stays shut for repairs, 20 days from the 13th[23]. My guess is Ganjam's trucks for Kandhamal keep taking the long way round, hours longer each way, until about 2nd November.

## CITY TRAFFIC UPDATES

City roads against usual, daily, 10–16 Oct[10] amber = 10+ over

**Chennai climbed all week, from 12 points over usual on Wednesday to 17 on Friday, the day the monsoon's first heavy rain waterlogged some of its main roads. Delhi held at 13 to 15 over. Kolkata eased to 12 over on Friday, then ran up to 38 over before dawn this morning, the Puja's Saptami.**




## HOW THIS IS MADE

At 7 every morning, Claude drafts this page on its own using data available from public sources only. It reads the morning's public signals: city traffic in ten cities, the JNPA and Paradip port reports, ship queues at the container ports, toll-plaza truck counts, the seasonal calendar and about twenty news searches.

Then it writes, and a set of checks decides whether the draft is even fit for me to read. Every claim has to be opened and cited, and no source can be over a week old without a reason. No story from the last seven days comes back unless it actually moved, and nothing gets said twice.

I read it, argue with it, fix what's wrong and approve it. The ratings are my judgement on the likelihood of on-time delivery or cost-impact, not measured service levels or actual cost estimates. Confidence is High when the facts are dated and primary or measured, Medium when they rest on a proxy or a forecast. Does that make the page right? Not always, which is why the calls get scored.

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## SOURCES


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13. Mint (PTI): Madurai creator flooded with cash-on-delivery orders, 16 Oct
14. ET Infra: 70 ships wait at Kandla, rice to load at an oil jetty, 15 Oct
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16. BBC Verify: ship attacks near Hormuz reach a record, 16 Oct
17. RuralVoice: Maharashtra cane farmers oppose early crushing, 16 Oct
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19. Deccan Herald: meet our demands and we'll call off the padayatra, 16 Oct
20. IHMCL: FASTag heavy-vehicle counts by toll plaza, October 2025
21. Maritime Gateway: Petrapole–Benapole cargo halt, 13 Oct
22. The Lallantop: 300 trucks at the Bengal border, 13 Oct
23. OdishaBytes: Kalinga ghat shut 20 days, 13 Oct